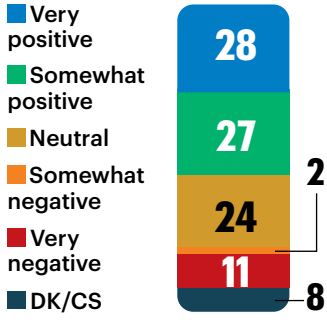
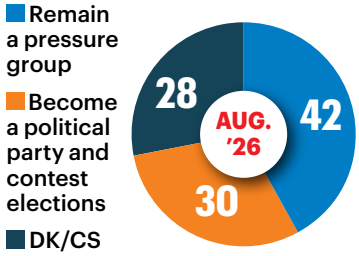
Q. What is your overall impression of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)?

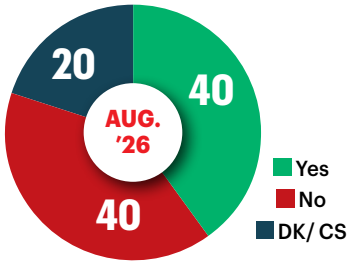


For the young, the CJP can do little that is wrong right now

Q. The CJP says it wants to remain a pressure group for now, rather than become a political party. What should it do?



Q. If the CJP contested elections, would you consider voting for it?



Support for the CJP runs far and wide, but voting for it? That will need a rethink

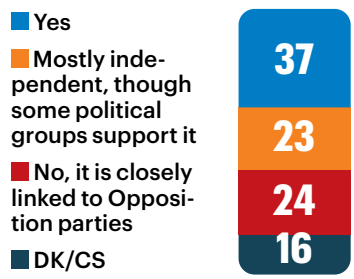
Q. What is the single most important thing the CJP needs, to be seen as a credible political alternative?



Rest DK/CS

If the CJP is looking to enter politics, they must prove themselves first

Q. Do you believe the CJP is genuinely independent of established political parties?



This independent image will be tough to sustain

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say

The sense of insecurity extends to whether their future lies in India at all. Some 37% believe the country is moving in the right direction against 46% who think otherwise

The frustration is spilling into politics and a search for alternatives outside the country's established parties

turns into anger. A striking 67 per cent have either little or no confidence in the fairness of India's entrance and government recruitment exams, with 40 per cent saying they have zero trust. The NEET paper leaks have clearly deepened this crisis of faith. Fifty-three per cent feel that the Union government's handling of the controversy was 'poor' or 'very poor', while 65 per cent believe the education minister's resignation was needed or should have come earlier.

That frustration is spilling into politics, and a search for alternatives outside the established parties like the Bharatiya Janata Party or the Congress. In fact, only 15 per cent believe existing political parties represent the concerns of young Indians adequately; 56 per cent say they do very little or nothing at all. That explains why its report card on the newly minted Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) is positive but far from an electoral endorsement. As many as 42 per cent believe the CJP should remain a pressure group, compared with only 30 per cent who want it to become a political party and contest elections. And if the CJP did contest, only 40 per cent say they would consider voting for it, while an equal share say they would not. Gen Z, in other words, is not prepared to hand a blank cheque to the CJP and want it to first to demonstrate clear policies, credible leadership and a record of providing solutions. That is indeed a sensible approach. ■